

NITYA SHANKAR

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EDUCATION

University of Washington

Seattle, WA

B.S. in Informatics, Human-Computer Interaction Track, GPA 3.83/4.0

Graduation: June 2028

- Relevant Coursework: INFO 360 (Design Methods), INFO 380 (Product and Information Systems Management)

CORE SKILLS

Prototyping Tools (Figma, Balsamiq) · User Research · HTML/CSS · Qualitative Analysis · Excel · Project Management

EXPERIENCE

Web & Operations Specialist

August 2026 – Present

UW Q Center

Seattle, WA

- Conducted a comprehensive accessibility audit of the Q Center website, identifying key areas of improvement and developing a project timeline toward WCAG 2.1 AA and Title II compliance by 2027.
- Redesigned information architecture for digital service distribution, improving user pathways to key LGBTQ+ community resources.
- Optimized inventory order fulfillment system by restructuring the data dictionary, improving operational accuracy and efficiency.

Research Assistant

June 2026 – Present

UW Information School (KidsTeam)

Seattle, WA

- Drive user-centered product design across research operations by executing intergenerational co-design sessions and translating insights from 20+ children into actionable ideas and prototypes.
- Formulate participatory design strategies by synthesizing findings from 18 academic publications and Directed Reading Group (DRG) sessions to ground future product development in rigorous user research.
- Conduct qualitative analysis of 3+ hours of session footage using thematic coding to examine children's relationships with autonomy and technology.

Project Manager

July 2023 – June 2025

Project Youth4Local

Issaquah, WA

- Coordinated student teams and City of Issaquah partners to increase visibility for 10+ local small businesses through digital and in-person marketing initiatives.
- Planned and led two annual marketing bootcamps, equipping 30+ students with practical digital marketing and branding skills.
- Produced a 20-page project report analyzing operations and outcomes, earning 1st place in WA DECA and 4th internationally.

PROJECTS

Page Friends | Figma, Google Sites

June 2026

- Designed and built a multi-page project portfolio website documenting a full UX design process for a children's literacy app.
- Developed a high-fidelity Figma prototype featuring onboarding, vocabulary, and reading interaction flows.
- Conducted user research and evaluation to inform design decisions, presenting findings through structured web documentation.

Musemap | Figma, UX Research

May 2026

- Co-led ideation and design rationale for a personalized Seattle museum app, synthesizing findings from 98 survey responses and 7 user interviews.
- Defined core feature set through competitive analysis of 3 existing products, identifying personalization and accessibility as key opportunity areas.
- Contributed to mid-fidelity prototype refinements based on usability testing with 3 participants.

HONORS & AWARDS

Dean's List | University of Washington

Fall '25, Winter '26, Spring '26

1st Place WA DECA, 4th Place International | Project Youth4Local

March 2025

Area 4 Member of the Year | Washington DECA

March 2025